

Henry ‘Orator’ Hunt

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Henry Hunt (1773–1835) was a leading political reformer and powerful public speaker, known as Henry “Orator” Hunt. After early personal difficulties, he became a campaigner for fairer government and the rights of ordinary people.

In the City of London, Hunt exposed corruption, demanded that public accounts were published, and challenged high salaries and waste. He often clashed with City leaders while calling for greater honesty and accountability.

In 1830, Hunt became MP for Preston and supported parliamentary reform and wider voting rights. In 1832, he presented the first petition to Parliament calling for women to have the vote, although it was rejected.

Hunt continued campaigning for reform until his death in 1835. He is remembered for his determination to improve government and make politics fairer for everyone.



Henry Hunt